

Synthetic-media Discourse Analysis

Facilitator field guide

Notice. Discuss. Check. Reflect.

VERSION 1.3 / 27 SEPT 2026



A visual companion for community groups, workshop hosts and trainers. Use the four activities to explore how media was made, compare different kinds of evidence and decide a practical next step.

The app brings Community Workshop, Developer and Facilitator guide together. Prepared examples open saved findings. These screenshots illustrate the workshop journey; the entered responses are examples for this guide.

An academic research project of **Synthetic Realities**, led by **Dr Sam Martin**, Smart Data Research UK (UKRI) Fellow (Grant number UKRI4010.), Manchester Metropolitan University (MMU). [ORCID: 0000-0002-4466-8374](https://orcid.org/0000-0002-4466-8374).

Open the interactive demo: sdavision.io

WORKSHOP ACTIVITY 1

1

Notice

Make room for first impressions.

What catches your eye?



AI-generated workshop illustration

Explore this illustration, or choose another example above.

How do you think it was made?

Choose all that fit, or choose "Not sure yet" on its own.

- ☐ Photographed
- ☒ Illustrated / hand-drawn
- ☐ Human-made
- ☐ Made with AI
- ☐ A mix of both
- ☐ Not sure yet

Your first impression: Illustrated / hand-drawn

What makes you think that? (optional)

Example response: the outlines and colours suggest an illustration.]

Let's discuss →

Workshop activity - prepared example and sample responses.

Questions for the group

- 1 Did different details catch people's attention?
- 2 Would anyone like more time to look or listen?
- 3 Which first impressions would you like to explore together?

Invite a quiet moment to look or listen. People can select more than one impression, add a note, or choose "Not sure yet".

Choose a shared example first. The opening illustration is labelled as AI-generated, so it works as a practice activity. For an initial-origin exercise, select an approved menu example.

WORKSHOP ACTIVITY 2

2

Discuss

Explore the reasons behind a view.

What helped you form that view?



AI-generated workshop illustration

Explore this illustration, or choose another example above.

What suggests drawing or illustration to you?

Your first impression: Illustrated / hand-drawn

What shaped your view? Choose any.

- ☐ Small visual details
- ☒ Light, shadows or textures
- ☐ Words, labels or claims
- ☐ Something I cannot place

You picked 1 cue. What other explanation might fit?

What did your conversation bring up? (optional)

We noticed different details and want to compare the findings.

[← Previous step](#)

[Let's check together →](#)

Workshop activity - prepared example and sample responses.

Questions for the group

- 1 Did someone notice something different?
- 2 Can the same detail have more than one explanation?
- 3 What question would help the group move forward?

Invite people to point to a detail and explain why it matters. Compare explanations before opening the findings.

Use "Let's check together" when the group is ready. People can revisit earlier responses throughout the activity.

WORKSHOP ACTIVITY 3

3

Check

Connect each finding to its evidence.

What can we find out together?



AI-generated workshop illustration

Explore this illustration, or choose another example above.

What we know so far

- Your first impression: Illustrated / hand-drawn**
A workshop source record has yet to be added for this item.

SDA's checks

Visual clues Is it authentic?	▶ Leans AI-made or altered
Shared claim What evidence supports its claim?	▼ Evidence to check together Compare the claim with its original source, supporting evidence and relevant expertise.

[View the supporting details below](#) ↓

← [Previous step](#)

[Reflect together](#) →

Workshop activity - prepared example and sample responses.

Questions for the group

- 1 What did each check cover?
- 2 Which findings come from a file record, a model or a person's observation?
- 3 Where could the group look for the missing evidence?

Use "Let's check together" in Discuss to open the saved findings. Compare their coverage with the group's first impressions. Direct entry to Check offers "Open recorded findings".

Expand "Find out why" beneath each reading. The Sound tab covers recording checks where relevant. Developer holds the full file record. Ratings are not calibrated probabilities.

WORKSHOP ACTIVITY 4

4

Reflect

Turn the discussion into a useful next step.

How do you see it now?

Your first impression
 Illustrated / hand-drawn

SDA's assessment
 The checks lean towards AI-made or altered content

Choose all that fit, or choose "Not sure yet" on its own.

☐ Photographed
☐ Illustrated / hand-drawn
☐ Human-made
☒ Made with AI
☐ A mix of both
☐ Not sure yet

Your view has moved from "Illustrated / hand-drawn" to "Made with AI". What influenced that change?

What would you do next? Choose any.

☐ Find the original source
[Open Google Lens](#) 
☒ [Download original file](#)
Use the camera icon to choose an image to share with Google. Google's account settings and terms apply separately from SDA.
☐ Compare with other evidence
☐ Ask someone with relevant expertise
☒ Pause before sharing

What will you take away? (optional)

I will compare the findings with the source and pause before sharing.

[← Previous step](#)

Questions for the group

- 1 What changed people's views, and what stayed uncertain?
- 2 Which next step feels practical in everyday life?
- 3 How would you explain the findings to someone else?

Guide the reflection

Invite a later view, a practical next action and an optional takeaway. A changed view and a remaining uncertainty can both contribute to the discussion.

Take the notes away

Choose PDF, PowerPoint or CSV. Include workshop responses when wanted. End session starts a download; New session offers saving and an acknowledgement before clearing the page.

Example responses are shown. The saved model assessment retains its original scores and date.

Make it your session

Before the group arrives

Open the public demo on the intended device and screen. Choose approved examples, test sound or the presentation's slide controls, and try a report download. Keep a saved copy of this guide available.

Keep participation flexible

Offer time to look or listen, think quietly, talk in pairs or respond aloud. People can pass and revisit a response. Agree what, if anything, the facilitator will record outside the app.

Choose the pace together

A short session can follow one example through all four activities. A longer workshop can compare media types. The same questions can support discussion before and after opening the saved findings.

Working with external checks

Reflect offers Google Lens for image examples, with Download original file alongside it. Other media keep three practical next steps. The Evidence box provides the available Second Opinion routes. Participants choose what they attach to an external service under its account settings and terms. Pasted replies and workshop notes are separate from the saved assessment.

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Credits and scope

Screenshots: SDA Vision, partners-2026-09-27.1. Opening illustration: Dr Sam Martin, Smart Data Research UK (UKRI) Fellow (Grant number UKRI4010.), Manchester Metropolitan University (MMU), 2026; AI-generated artwork. Saved opening-image model analysis: 26 September 2026. Podcast findings concern a transcript excerpt; AI-origin detection from the sound itself is outside this workflow.

SDA: Synthetic-media Discourse Analysis. Guide version 1.3. Screens and guidance reflect the current public demo. MIT licence; project and illustration attribution retained. Partner logos identify the affiliation and funding; their rights remain with their owners.

[Open the interactive demo](#)